

Media Pitch Sheet

Alberta's Disability System Breakdown — A Story With Documents

A press packet for journalists covering the July 1, 2026 AISH-to-ADAP transition. Three story angles. Sourced statistics. Direct quotes. A complete document library to draw from.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — April 2026 Report Series

On July 1, 2026, the Government of Alberta will move 79,290 people with permanent disabilities to a new program. The criteria have not been published. The appeal rights have been removed. The federal benefit designed to help has been clawed back. And the children's disability waitlist serving the same families is three years long.

This is a story with documents. The documents are public. The numbers are the government's own.

ABOUT THIS PACKET

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown is a community-led documentation campaign comprising 19 sourced reports tracking the simultaneous restructuring of disability income, healthcare access, child disability services, and appeal rights in Alberta. Every figure in the series is traced to government open data, Statistics Canada releases, peer-reviewed research, or primary-source government correspondence. Every document is free to share, free to quote, and free to reproduce.

This pitch sheet is for journalists. Below: three story angles, the strongest stats and quotes for each, recommended documents to draw from, and a contact line for the campaign.

THREE STORY ANGLES

Angle 1 — “The Only Province in Canada”

The hook: Alberta is the only province or territory in Canada to claw back the federal Canada Disability Benefit dollar-for-dollar from its disability income recipients. Every other province exempts the \$200/month CDB. Alberta deducts it.

Why it's a story: The CDB was created by the federal government in 2024 explicitly as a poverty-reduction supplement. Alberta has redirected approximately \$190 million per year of federal anti-poverty funding into its

own general revenue. The Heritage Fund grew \$383 million in a single quarter (Q3 2025-26) — more than the entire annual CDB clawback.

Quotable lead stats:

- \$200/month — the federal Canada Disability Benefit. Clawed back dollar-for-dollar by Alberta.
- ~\$190 million/year — total annual CDB clawback redirected to Alberta general revenue.
- \$2.8 billion — deposited into the Alberta Heritage Fund from the 2024-25 surplus.
- \$4 million — cut from homelessness funding in the same budget.
- 0 other provinces or territories — claw the CDB back.

Documents to draw from: Financial Reality Report · Taxpayer and Heritage Fund Report · Access Barrier Report.

Best outlets for this angle: Toronto Star · Globe and Mail · CBC National · CBC Calgary/Edmonton · Tyee · Maclean's. The “only province in Canada” framing is a national story, not just an Alberta story.

Angle 2 — The Municipal Coalition Forming Against the Province

The hook: Multiple Alberta municipalities — Edmonton, Lethbridge, Red Deer, Claresholm, Camrose, with Calgary and Medicine Hat in discussion — have passed or introduced motions formally opposing the AISH-to-ADAP transition. This is elected city councils on record against a provincial program.

Why it's a story: Municipalities are not anti-poverty advocacy organizations. They are governments with property tax bases. Their opposition is grounded in a documented fiscal concern: the downloading of homelessness, emergency healthcare, and crisis-services costs from the province onto cities. *“We’re very concerned about the downloading effect of this policy change onto municipalities,”* said Edmonton Councillor Keren Tang in March 2026.

Quotable lead stats:

- 5+ Alberta municipalities — formally on record with motions opposing the ADAP transition (as of April 2026).
- Edmonton's motion — passed unanimously. Mayor Andrew Knack sent a formal letter to Minister Nixon.
- Lethbridge's motion — passed unanimously. Council chambers were standing room only. Chamber erupted in applause when the vote passed.
- \$55,000/year — taxpayer cost of one homeless person (Calgary Housing First evaluation).
- \$23,280/year — annual AISH benefit. The cost of housing someone is less than half the cost of not.

Documents to draw from: Coalition and UN CRPD Addendum · Taxpayer and Heritage Fund Report · Housing Crisis Report.

Best outlets for this angle: CBC Edmonton · CBC Calgary · Edmonton Journal · Calgary Herald · Lethbridge Herald · Red Deer Advocate · Future of Good. Each has a regional municipal beat and active interest in this story.

Angle 3 — Bill 12 and the End of Independent Appeal Rights

The hook: On December 9, 2025, Alberta's Bill 12 passed — eliminating the independent Citizens Appeal Panel for AISH and ADAP eligibility decisions. 79,290 Albertans with permanent disabilities lost the right to challenge a government decision through an independent body. The Medical Review Panel's decisions are now final.

Why it's a story: This is a documented removal of due process from a population defined by a protected characteristic — disability. It engages Section 15 of the Charter (equality rights), Article 13 of the UN CRPD (access to justice, ratified by Canada in 2010), and the foundational administrative-law principle that no one should be a judge in their own cause. The same ministry that benefits financially from caseload reduction now controls the panel that decides who stays on the caseload — with no independent review.

Quotable lead stats:

- 79,290 — Albertans on AISH (September 2025).
- 0 — independent appeal mechanisms remaining for AISH or ADAP eligibility decisions.
- \$77 million — projected AISH spending reductions over three years (the financial benefit to the ministry that controls the appeal panel).
- 24% — the documented completion rate for online Disability Tax Credit applications (federal data) — a comparable disability form. The administrative complexity itself is a barrier.
- March 26, 2025 — date the UN Committee on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities recommended Canada “*condition fiscal transfers from the Federal level to provinces and territories on their adherence to the CRPD.*” Bill 12 passed nine months later.

Documents to draw from: Prior Finding Report · Caseworker / Appeal Rights / Human Rights Report · Coalition and UN CRPD Addendum.

Best outlets for this angle: Canadian Lawyer · CBC The Current · The Tyee · Policy Options · Globe and Mail (national affairs) · ARCH Disability Law Centre press list.

CROSS-CUTTING STATS — USABLE IN ANY ANGLE

These figures are sourced and verified. Each is referenced in the report series.

FIGURE	CONTEXT	SOURCE
79,290	Total Albertans on AISH (September 2025)	Government of Alberta Open Data
83.6%	AISH recipients with zero employment income	Government of Alberta Open Data

FIGURE	CONTEXT	SOURCE
26.4%	Employment rate for Canadians with severe disabilities	Statistics Canada Labour Market 2024
650,000	Albertans without a family doctor	Alberta Medical Association
887 → 164	Family practices accepting new patients, 2020 → 2024	Alberta Medical Association / U of Calgary
61%	Family physicians considering leaving Alberta's healthcare system	ThinkHQ / AMA, January 2024
47%	Increase in emergency department psychiatric crisis visits (Alberta, before transition)	Alberta Doctors' Digest, Nov/Dec 2025
5.5% vs. 12%	Alberta mental health budget vs. Mental Health Commission of Canada recommended minimum	CMHA Edmonton 2024
3 years	Average wait for full FSCD services (children's disability supports)	Inclusion Alberta FSCD Survey, January 2025
400+	Families documented per FSCD caseworker (recommended max: 100)	Hold My Hand Alberta / AUPE
\$1,940/month	Current AISH benefit	Government of Alberta
\$1,500–\$1,900+	Average 1-bedroom rent in Alberta (2026)	Urbanation/Rentals.ca National Rent Report
\$40	Approximate monthly remainder for food, utilities, transportation, and medication after rent for many recipients	Calculated from above

WHY THIS IS AN INVESTIGATIVE STORY, NOT A PROTEST STORY

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown is not built around individual hardship narratives. It is built around documented contradictions in the government's own record:

- **The “fiscal necessity” framing** — contradicted by the government's own Budget 2026, which shows program planning and delivery for disability income assistance increased \$41.6 million year-over-year

(2025-26 to 2026-27). The transition costs nearly as much to administer as the benefit cut is projected to save.

- **The “supportive employment” framing** — contradicted by the same government introducing the Immigration Oversight Act on April 1, 2026, formally acknowledging that Alberta workers were being bypassed for jobs. Work permit holders in Alberta grew from 45,000 to 180,000 between 2021 and 2025.
- **The “thoughtful consultation” framing** — contradicted by Minister Nixon’s own April 3, 2026 letter, which confirmed that the Ministerial Order governing employment income calculations would not be set until “*later this spring*” — 88 days before the July 1, 2026 launch.
- **The “wraparound supports” promise** — contradicted by the Family Resource Centre of Central Alberta closing on April 1, 2026, after five years of service to families with disabilities, when provincial advocacy funding was cut twelve months early.
- **The “prior assessments stand” position** — contradicted by the program design itself, which treats 79,290 formal disability findings as provisional without publishing any analysis of why.

These are not interpretive disputes. They are facts on record, measurable against the government’s own documents.

WHAT JOURNALISTS CAN DO WITH THIS PACKET

- **Quote the campaign directly.** All documents are free to reproduce in whole or in part with attribution to “*The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — April 2026 Report Series.*” No clearance required.
- **Use the statistics.** Every figure in the series is sourced. The source notes accompany each report. Footnotes can be lifted.
- **Verify independently.** Government open data sources, Statistics Canada releases, and peer-reviewed research are cited throughout. The campaign welcomes independent verification.
- **Request the full library.** The campaign maintains 19 documents covering financial reality, healthcare access, mental health coverage, FSCD/PDD waitlists, employment reality, prior findings, the access barrier chain, the human cost, the taxpayer cost, the municipal coalition, and a practical action guide for recipients. Available on request.
- **Speak to coalition contacts.** Where reporters want regional voices, the Coalition Addendum names elected officials and community advocates who have agreed to engage with media on this story.

CONTACT THE CAMPAIGN

For documents, statistics, source verification, or coalition contacts — reach the campaign directly at the public address below. The campaign operates without spokespeople and does not place advocates in front of cameras as personal stories. It does provide documents, sourced data, and pointers to elected officials and community organizations who are speaking publicly on this issue.

Press contact — Alberta Disability System Breakdown

albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com

Public Facebook group: facebook.com/share/g/1CrU5PfHha/

Document library: albertadisabilitysystembreakdown.netlify.app

A NOTE ON SOURCING

Every document in this series is structured around three principles:

- **Government data first.** Where the government has published a number, that number is used — even where the campaign disagrees with the framing around it. The campaign does not contest the data. It documents the contradictions inside it.
- **No anonymous sourcing.** Every statistic is attributed to a named source — Statistics Canada, the Alberta Medical Association, CBC News, the Government of Alberta, peer-reviewed research, or named coalition members.
- **Primary sources are held.** Where the campaign documents barrier chains, communication failures, or compliance histories, the underlying correspondence and receipts are held on file with the campaign and available for verification on request.

This is documentation. It is meant to be checked.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — Advocate

St. Albert, Alberta | April 2026

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Find the public group on Facebook: *facebook.com/share/g/1CrU5PfHha/*